

cheap.market

The shopping layer for affordable fashion born in social feeds

A social-first marketplace for trend-driven fashion & lifestyle products

TRACTION

A proven engine

Trailing 12 months · Jul 2025 - Jun 2026

\$489K

Gross GMV · \$489K (\$386K net)

14.3K

Orders

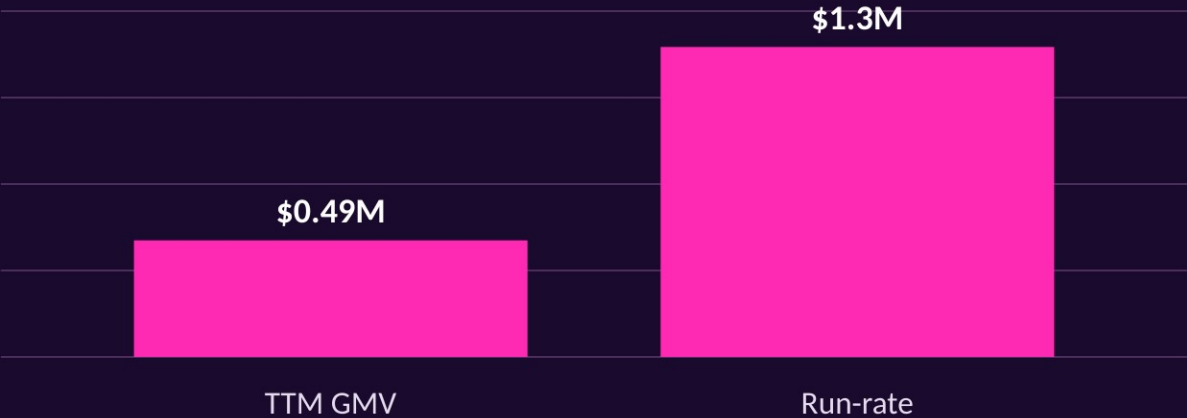
7.6K

Buyers

\$1.3M

Annualized run-rate · \$1.3M

GMV (\$M)



Current monthly pace is $\approx 2.7\times$ the trailing-twelve-month average.

UNIT ECONOMICS

Cheap acquisition, healthy basket size



\$8

Paid CAC per buyer



\$0.09

TikTok CPI per install



\$34

AOV, gross (\$27 net)



11-13.5%

Repeat in the first 3 months



CAC is $\approx 23\%$ of a single first order: there is room to scale spend as repeat purchases compound.

PROBLEM

Young women want to look stylish, but at a price they can afford

Gen Z and Alpha discover fashion in the feed, not through search



Discovery lives in the feed

They see a trend on TikTok or Pinterest and want to buy it immediately.



Buying is fragmented

Hunting across platforms and decoding Chinese listings.



Every order is a gamble

Size, quality and delivery are all risks.



It feels like importing

Not shopping, but “ordering from China.”

SOLUTION

A social-first marketplace with a trust layer



Curated supply

Vetted suppliers and manufacturers from China.



Personalized feed

TikTok and Pinterest trends and looks for Gen Z and Alpha.



Trust layer

Size help, quality check and a pre-ship photo with opt-out.



Group orders

Buy together with friends and share the shipping.



We prepare the feed for the target audience in advance: select seasonal trends and looks from TikTok and Pinterest, then find the products from suppliers. The emotion: “I saw it in a meme - I want the same thing” and “the whole feed already feels familiar” (entry through TikTok/Pinterest).



Our prices are lower on average than competitors: verified on 1,000 products in a test soft-launch region.

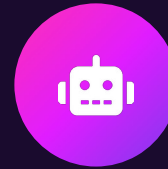
WHY NOW

AI lets a small team build a Temu-class operation



Before

Catalog, translation, recommendations, moderation, support, logistics and creatives all required a large team.



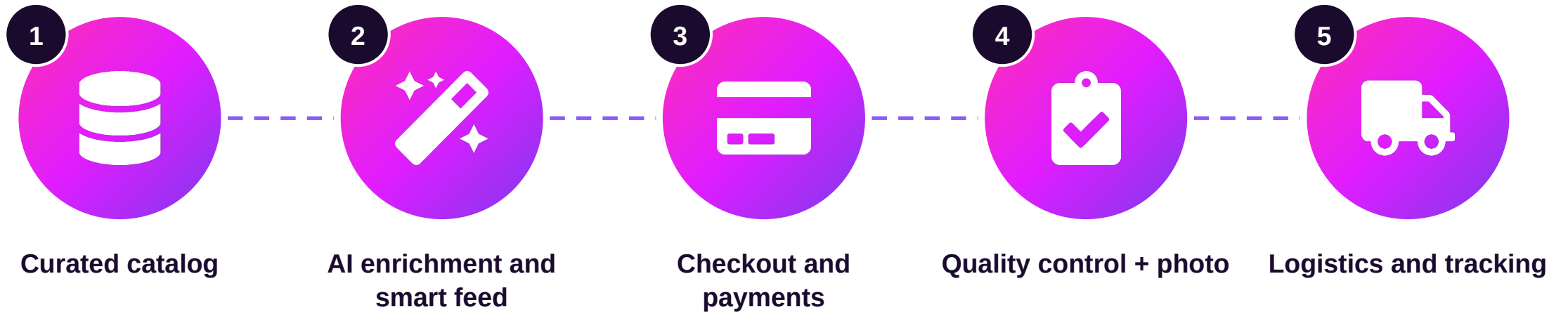
Core today

AI automates most of the stack. A small team can build a more personal, higher-quality marketplace, faster.

► *The window is open now: whoever builds the vertical AI marketplace first takes the category.*

PRODUCT

How it works



The value is not access to Chinese supply, but the trust and personalization layer on top of it.

MARKET

TAM / SAM / SOM: where we fit in the market



TAM $\approx$ \$1.1-1.2T

Global fashion e-commerce; Gen Z/Alpha are becoming key growth drivers.



SAM $\approx$ \$150-200B

Affordable fashion (fast fashion + casual wear) for Gen Z/Alpha online: discovered through TikTok, Instagram and social media.



SOM $\approx$ \$10-20B

3-5 years: mobile-first social commerce in emerging markets with cross-border supply. Target: 1-2% of the segment.

Sources: Research and Markets · Fortune Business Insights · Capital One Shopping

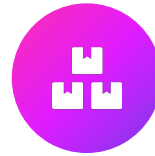
cheap.market is a vertical AI marketplace for Gen Z/Alpha affordable fashion. We start with a wedge inside the \$150-200B segment that grows faster than the market thanks to social discovery and cross-border shopping.

Social-first demand, curated supply



Demand

- TikTok-first performance + organic UGC and creator-style content
- High creative volume, fast testing



Supply

- Vetted suppliers and manufacturers from China
- Our own curated pool, no middlemen
- No seller acquisition needed

TikTok test: 292 videos · 23.9M views · 363K installs · \$0.09 CPI · +30% ROI at 12 months

LIVE TESTS

Seedings with local creators: Argentina, USA, Brazil and Mexico

BUSINESS MODEL

How we make money



Core today

Margin on every order.

Expansion revenue (planned)



**Seller onboarding →
commission**



**Ads and promoted
placements**



**B2B: wholesale for
businesses**



**Vertical niches: furniture,
apparel, supplements**

► *Strong signal today: cheap acquisition and positive ROI at 6-12 months.*

TEAM

Founder



Aleksei Balchunas

16+ years in tech and product: AI, mobile, social and e-commerce

- Co-founder / CTO / CEO at 4SPACES

Built AI Boost, CamOn, Imba and Caramel

Hypee and AI Boost were acquired (~\$3.1M and \$450K)

Hands-on: TikTok/Meta performance, funnel analytics, ML pipelines, scalable backend and e-commerce aggregators

THE ASK

What we are raising



The train is already moving: 2.7× growth and 4 markets launching. The round is fuel to take the category while the window is open.

pre-seed / seed · open on structure: SAFE / convertible / equity

Use of funds



**Scale TikTok
acquisition**



**AI recommendations
and catalog**



**Logistics and quality
control**



Product team



**Grow the supplier
network**

VISION

Native shopping for young social-media users

Not “search for a product”, but a personal stream of trend pieces with clear prices and safe checkout. In 3-5 years: millions of users, a proprietary trend data/AI layer, a broad supplier network, strong logistics and localization.

cheap.market

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APPENDIX

Sources

Public sources for market estimates and theses. Internal metrics (GMV, CAC, unit economics) are our own data and are not publicly verifiable.

Audience and discovery (Gen Z/Alpha)

[eMarketer](#) · [Sprout Social](#) · [YouGov](#)

Gen Z/Alpha as growth drivers

[Bain & Company \(overview\)](#)

Fashion e-commerce (TAM)

[Research and Markets](#) · [ECDB](#) · [Statista](#)

Vertical AI and niche marketplaces

[vc.ru \(overview\)](#)

Fast fashion + casual wear (SAM)

[Fortune Business Insights](#) · [Global Market Insights](#)

Temu / Shein expansion

[Business of Fashion](#)

Cross-border e-commerce (SOM)

[Capital One Shopping](#) · [Precedence Research](#)

Founder exits (Hypee, AI Boost)

[PitchBook](#)

Social commerce

[Mordor Intelligence](#) · [Grand View Research](#)